

Bible

Old Testament
New Testament
Church History





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Old Testament: Grades 3-6, New Testament: Grades 3-6, Church History: Grades 4-6

About Old Testament: Grades 3-6

Students in Grades 3-6 read Old Testament narratives chronologically. For 2026-2027, students read selections from Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and 1-2 Samuel. Lesson plans also include selections from maps and books such as *The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times*, which teachers can read or share with their students to help them understand the biblical context and gain insight into the culture and geography of Israel.

About New Testament: Grades 3-6

Each year, students in Grades 3-6 read one of the gospels. For 2026-2027 they read John. Lesson plans include map work and assigned selections of *The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times* for teachers to read with their students before or after Bible reading to help give context and insight into the culture and geography of Israel during Jesus' life.

About Church History: Grades 4-6

Each year in elementary grades, students read biographies of influential people from church history. This course features the stories of Christians from Alveary's modern history rotation for the years (1800-1900).



Placement & Combining Tips

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

Suitable for older students if combining lessons, and ideal for older students just getting familiar with the Bible.

New Testament: Grades 3-6

Suitable for older students if combining lessons, and ideal for older students just getting familiar with the Bible.

Church History: Grades 4-6

Those who wish to combine students in Grades 4-6 with younger students should choose either this course or the Church History for grades 1-3. If you have a 6th grader, they could be combined with the 7-8 Church History course.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6 2 times/week 20 min	ESV Large Print Bible The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times
3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6 2 times/week 20 min	ESV Large Print Bible The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times
4-6	Church History: Grades 4-6 1 time/week 20 min	Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 4-6				



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Bible: Grades 4-6

Old Testament: Grades 3-6



ESV Large Print Bible



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times

New Testament: Grades 3-6



ESV Large Print Bible



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times

Church History: Grades 4-6



Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China



Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Bible: Grades 4-6

- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 6: Bible\)](#)
- ∞ [How can we find the original meaning of the text?](#)
- ∞ [How do we help students learn to interpret the Bible?](#)
- ∞ [How does learning about the Ancient Near East world help us understand the Bible?](#)
- ∞ [What is the role of the Holy Spirit when reading the Bible?](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Bible: Grades 4-6

How To Teach



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Read

- Read the chapter or selection aloud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the students' pace during the lesson, rather than feeling that a particular number of pages must be completed. It is vitally important that teachers not overload students with more material than they can absorb in one sitting.
- Students who have difficulty sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Students with regular difficulty engaging often benefit from having a picture to associate with the story WHILE listening. Feel free to view the artwork during the reading rather than after the narration.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



View

- Optional: Share a piece of fine art that illustrates the story.



Discuss

- Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
-



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 1

Introduction to Joshua

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

PREP: The teacher may wish to read the article linked here that explains the genre of Historical or Historical Narrative books of the Bible. The focus is always on who God is (known as the theology of God) while the history of his people is told.

∞ Article Link: [Introduction to the Old Testament Historical Books](#)

→ INTRO

This year in the Old Testament, we will read five books: Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1 and 2 Samuel. These books continue the story of Israel so that when we open our Bible to the book of Joshua, it is as though we are starting to read in the middle of a story where important events and people have already been introduced and discussed.

In order to understand what is going to happen next, let's do a short review of what has happened so far. The first five books of the Bible are a group of books called the Pentateuch. The Pentateuch is the books of Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, and Deuteronomy. The next set or category has twelve books in it and is called Historical or Historical Narrative. We will read the first five of these books this year. Historical narrative books show us who God is while the story of his people, the Israelites, is told. When you read a historical narrative book, you will see that it answers the question, "And then what happened?"

What do you recall about what has happened so far in the life of Israel? (Students may mention Abraham, Moses, being in Egypt, plagues in Egypt, crossing the Red Sea, etc.)

Leaders of Israel have included Abraham, who received a promise from God that He would bless him with land, people, and many blessings. Next, the nation of Israel was led by Moses. Moses led the people as they escaped from Egypt, crossed the Red Sea, and wandered in the wilderness.

God made a covenant (promise) with Moses that if the people followed God, they would be blessed. But if they disobeyed, they would be cursed (things would not go well for them). For today's reading, we are going to read a passage from the book of Deuteronomy where the covenant God made with Moses is written about. As we read Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and First and Second Samuel, these promises will be underlying the decisions the people and leaders of Israel make, so it is an important chapter to keep in our minds as we read. Will they continue to follow God, or will they forget about him and turn to their own selfish ways? We will find out as we read the Historical Narrative books and find out the answer to "And then what happened?"

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Deuteronomy 28:1-10, 15-19, 25

- What did God promise (or covenant) with the people of Israel?

→ NOTEBOOK

This year, you will keep a notebook. Suggestions will be given in lessons for drawing or writing what you have read about, but you can always add drawings or writings of your own choosing as well.

Today, open up your notebook and create a title page with the heading: Old Testament.

As time and ability allow, write the names of the books we will be covering this year: Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1 Samuel, and 2 Samuel. You can also write the genre of these books: Historical Narrative



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 1

Intro to the Gospel of John

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

PREP:

Teachers may wish to view the Bible Project video on the first half of John in preparation for teaching.

∞ Video Link: Bible Project: John (Covers first half of book)

→ INTRO

For our New Testament reading this year, we will be looking at the fourth Gospel in the New Testament, the book of John. The John who wrote the book is one of the twelve disciples that followed Jesus closely throughout his ministry on earth. He also wrote the books of First, Second, Third John and the book of Revelation.

The book of John was written somewhere between 85-95 A.D., which makes it the last of the four gospels written and he includes some details the others left out and skips over some events that the other three gospel writers included. He writes to both Jews and Gentiles. (A Gentile is anyone who is not Jewish.)

→ READ & NARRATE

Today we will look at a few verses to set a foundation for our reading this year.

We do not have to guess why John wanted to write his gospel, because he states that reasoning very clearly in his gospel.

Read John 20:30-31

• Why does John say he wrote his gospel?

Read John 13:23, 20:2; 21:7, 20

• How does John speak about himself in relation to Jesus?

→ NOTEBOOK

As you read through the book of John, you will keep a notebook. Today, you will begin this notebook by making a title page.

On your title page, write the name of the book, the author, and the approximate date the book was written, 85-95 A.D. On your title page, copy down John 20:30-31, the verses stating the purpose of the book. (Students may write as little or as much as time and ability allow. You could also time to complete this task in lesson 2, if needed.)

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 2

Joshua Commissioned

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook, Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the intro to Joshua from last time?

→ INTRO

Before he died, Moses passed on the leadership of the people of Israel to Joshua (Deut. 31:7-8). In today's reading, Joshua will speak to the people about entering the Promised Land—the nation of Canaan. As Joshua speaks, he reminds the people of what they should do to have success and blessings. He also says, "Be strong and courageous." The reason the people could be strong and courageous is because the Lord was going with them and preparing their way. As we read, count how many times you hear this phrase or words similar to this.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 1:1-18



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- How many times did he say "Be strong and courageous"? Why do you think he repeated that command?
- How would you feel if you were an Israelite about to enter the Promised Land?

→ MAP WORK

📄 Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.8-9 Maps 4 and 5

1. At the end of Deuteronomy, we are told that before he died, Moses "went up from the plains of Moab to Mount Nebo" (Deut. 34:1) and was shown the Promised Land. On Map 4 (the larger map), locate Moab, the Jordan River (labeled as "R. Jordan"), and Canaan.
2. Look at the image in the bottom right-hand corner to see the view from Mount Nebo.
3. Looking at Map 5, locate Mt Nebo and the Jordan River. Follow the arrows to see the direction the Israelites will move forward in the book of Joshua. The Jordan River moves north to south, and to the east is a plateau (mostly flat, level ground) and mountains to the left. The people are approaching Canaan from the south. The first move they will have to make is to cross the Jordan River.

→ NOTEBOOK

In your notebook, create a title page for the book of Joshua. Draw a picture of Joshua speaking to the Israelites as their new leader. As time and ability allow, write the phrase "Be strong and courageous." Older students might write a short summary of the passage or a key verse from the passage.

WEEK 1 📅 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 2

The Word Was God

📄 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook (optional)

NOTE: Today's lesson has a video that is a helpful explanation of the opening of John's gospel. Although some of the concepts may be a bit intricate for younger students, the overall look at this passage gives helpful context to John's opening words.

→ RECAP

What do you recall what we read about last time about the introduction to the book of John?

→INTRO

Instead of starting with the birth of Jesus or with the story of John the Baptist as the other three gospels do, John begins his gospel with showing that Jesus is the Son of God, and is 100% God and 100% human. The book of John starts with "In the beginning." This reminds us of Genesis 1:1, the very first verse of the Bible which begins with the exact same phrase: In the beginning.

Also, in today's reading, another man named John the Baptist is mentioned. These are two separate individuals with the same name. John the author tells us what the role of John the Baptist was.

→ READ & NARRATE

John 1:1-13

→ VIEW & NARRATE

Watch the video at the link for an overview and explanation of John 1.

∞ Video Link: John 1

→ NOTEBOOK

If additional time was needed to copy down verse 20:30-31, you may complete that today.



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WEEK 1 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 1

Introduction to George Müller

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller, globe or wall map

→ INTRO

This year in Church History, we are reading about Christians from the past who lived between the years 1800-1900 AD. You will read about people who loved God, loved the Bible, and wanted others to know the good news that salvation is found in Jesus Christ. They followed God even when it was hard, and they faced difficulty.

The first book we will read is "The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller," where we are introduced to George Müller, a historical person who lived a life of pursuing God through faith and prayer. In the story, a fictional (made-up) character named Curly Roddy is introduced, who the authors use to introduce us to George Müller's life of faith. Curly was an orphan. What do you know about orphans? An orphan was a child whose mother and father had died, or had one parent who died, and the other parent couldn't take care of the child properly. In the late 1800s, only children who had money in their families could afford to live in an orphanage. That's why Curly lived on the streets and, in the story, tries to steal money and is hungry for food.

Thankfully, the historical figure of George Müller loved Jesus and wanted to show that love to orphans by opening orphanages for children who may not be able to help pay for their care. George Müller was born in 1805 and became a Christian when he was 20 years old, when his friend took him to a Bible study. After that, George decided to become a missionary and moved to London, England. During that time, he met a friend, Henry Craik, who would be his friend for life as they shared the Gospel message and ministered to children.

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: globe or wall map
Find London, England on a globe or wall map.

→ READ & NARRATE

Note on p.5 (un-numbered page) "George Muller founded" - "faith is true."
Ch.1 p.9-16 "Curly Roddy yanked" - "began to slide."

→ VIEW

You may want to print out this picture and hang it on your timeline.
∞ Image Link: Picture of George Müller

• IMPORTANT DATES

1805 - George Muller is Born

• DEFINITIONS

sexton - a person whose job is to take care of a church and the area around it, and ring the church bell
pickpocket - a person who steals from people's pockets, or the actual act of stealing money

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 3

Rahab Hides the Spies

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs of Bible Times

NOTE: Two different options are given for the reading from Manners & Customs. Choose which one best fits the age or the interests of your student(s). This book will be used throughout the year to give background explanation of the customs of the people at the time. Because the book covers the entire Bible, at times other verses will be referenced, but selections have been chosen to give background to the Old Testament books we are reading.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



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→ INTRO

Joshua is going to send two spies into the land to check it out. Maybe he thought back to how he had once been a spy for Moses!

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 2:1-24

- Deuteronomy 28:10 says, "And all the peoples of the earth shall see that you are called by the name of the Lord, and they shall be afraid of you." How does what Rahab says and does agree with (or prove) this verse from Deuteronomy? (If needed, see Josh. 2:9-11, 24)

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Rahab's family lived in a house that was part of the walls of Jericho. Read the following passage for an idea of what this may have looked like.

Manners & Customs "Brick Houses"

Younger students: View the illustrations and read p.28 "When the semi-nomadic" - "stone was white."; p.30-31 "The flat roof" - "in Matthew 24:17."

Older students, or as time and interest allow: View the illustrations and read p.28-31 "When the semi-nomadic" - "in Matthew 24:17."

WEEK 2 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 3

The Word Dwelt Among Us

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 1:14-27

→ READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: What does it mean that the Word dwelt among us

For younger students: Begin with the fourth paragraph "Not only did the Word..."-end

Older students: Read the entire answer starting with "In John 1:14"

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students may draw a picture of what we have read so far in John, or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary, or write down what they have learned about Jesus dwelling or being "tabernacled" among us.

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 4

Crossing the Jordan

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read in Joshua last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 3:7-17; 4:15-24

- How would the stones help the children (or future generations) remember what happened at the Jordan River? If you were there and someone asked you what the stones were for, what would you answer?
- What do God's miracles tell us about God?

→ NOTEBOOK



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Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage. Older students may pick a key verse or phrase from today's reading to write as well.

WEEK 2 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 4

Behold!

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ INTRO

The next verses continue speaking about John the Baptist and his testimony regarding his baptizing of Jesus. He testifies to Jesus, and the people who hear him begin following Jesus. As the Bible Project states, "One by one as people encounter Jesus, they say out loud who they think he is. In this one chapter, Jesus is given seven titles: the Lamb of God, Son of God, Rabbi, Messiah, King of Israel, Jesus of Nazareth, and the Son of Man."

Today we will begin a list of the titles people give when they see Jesus, in our next reading, we will read the rest of these titles. These seven titles claim Jesus as the Messiah and Savior of the world.

In the passage, we also see Jesus call his first two disciples. In New Testament times it was not unusual for Rabbis - or Teachers - to have disciples who would follow and learn from these teachers.

→ READ & NARRATE

John 1:28-39

●As Simon Peter and Andrew did, what would it be like to drop everything and begin following Jesus as his disciple?

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students, draw a picture either of John the Baptist speaking about Jesus OR of Simon Peter and Andrew following after Jesus. Older students may write a summary, or begin a list of the seven names given to Jesus in this chapter. (The three from today's reading would be: Lamb of God, Rabbi (Teacher) and Messiah (Christ).) Write the name and the verse reference where the title is found.

WEEK 2 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 2

Escape from the Tower

 Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading when we met the character of Curly Roddy?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, we learn a little more about Curly, including the fact that he had nine brothers and sisters. After their parents died, they were separated and put in different places. Sometimes orphans would be sent to workhouses, where they would have to work for long days. Others would be sent to help out in houses or businesses. Since the character of Curly did not have an adult helping him, he chose to work for a criminal and made choices that led him to running away from the man at the church.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Church with Belfry

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview the sensitive content on p.21 that talks about the father's behavior and the loss of Curly's parents.

On p.22, preview the first paragraph describing the butcher's treatment of Curly and p.23 where Curly gets punched and challenged to a fight.



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The image linked is of a church similar to what is being described in the book. The word "belfry" refers to where the bells were kept. Can you see the belfry in the image of the bell tower?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.16-24 "Flipping quickly to" - "pounds are missing?"

- What does the story say happened to Curly after his parents died, and why is he now living on the streets? How do you think this led to him working for Spuds by stealing money?

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 5

The Walls Fall

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. Israel celebrates Passover and remembers how God has delivered them from Egypt.

Read Joshua 5:10-15.

- In verse 12, it says the manna stopped. How do you think the Israelites felt about that?

2. Read Joshua 6:1-19.

Jericho is the first city the Israelites need to conquer, as Jericho protects the entry into the land from the east, where they crossed the Jordan. Scholars say Jericho "was about a twelve-acre site...[and] Based on the size of the site today, it seems that it might have taken Joshua's army less than half an hour to march around the city walls...In the ancient world every war was holy war because people believed that their gods called them to war, led them in battle, and fought on their behalf...For this assault it was the ark and the priests that gave indication of God's presence with the Israelites and made it plain that the battle belonged to the Lord." (Bible Story Handbook, Walton) Usually, when an army defeated a city or people, they would take the plunder or goods (such as jewelry and anything that was worth a lot). In this case, the people did not take anything, because it wasn't they that claimed the victory—it was God who won this battle.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Sound of the Shofar

View the video showing various Jewish people blowing the shofar, the ram's horn trumpet that was used in Israel's history—and is still used today—to call people to worship. What would it have been like to hear this sound if you were part of the army marching around Jericho?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of what you read today. Older students might write out a key verse from this passage or write a longer summary.

WEEK 3 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 5

Philip and Nathanael are Called

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE



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John 1:40-51

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students may add on to the picture of Simon Peter and Andrew following Jesus by adding Philip and Nathanael OR they may write a short summary of the passage. Older students, continue your list of titles or names Jesus is given by those who behold him. Include the reference where each title is found. (The titles would be: Jesus of Nazareth, Son of God, King of Israel, Son of Man.)

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 6

Achan's Sin

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Last time, we saw that the people did not take any of the plunder from Jericho as they were directed by God: "But all silver and gold, and every vessel of bronze and iron, are holy to the Lord; they shall go into the treasury of the Lord." (6:19) The word "plunder" means the valuables or possessions that would be taken from the people defeated in war. Armies that won battles would take the plunder not only to celebrate the victory, but to add the loot to their money pile so they could afford to keep battling! After the battle at Jericho, everyone followed this rule and listened...except Achan.

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 7:1-25

"When Achan took goods as plunder, it was like making a claim that the Israelites had won the battle rather than the Lord."

→ READ & DISCUSS

Manners & Customs of the Bible "War and religion" (See note above.) p.268-269 "It was not" - "his own people."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview verses 24 and 25 where Achan and his family are killed because of his disobedience.

Preview Manners & Customs reading regarding warfare. Either summarize or skip the couple of sentences that may not be appropriate for younger students.

WEEK 3 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 6

Wedding at Cana

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ INTRO

John's gospel includes signs to point to Jesus as Messiah. These miracles (signs) are contained in the first few chapters of the book, and some refer to chapters 1-12 as "The Book of Signs." In John's purpose statement for his gospel, he stated that Jesus did many signs during his ministry on earth, and these miracles or signs are included so that people would believe Jesus was the Messiah (John 20:30-31). In other words, these signs were pointing at who Jesus is. Today's reading will include the first of these signs.

→ READ & NARRATE

John 2:1-12

Weddings often went on for seven days and frequently the best wine would be served at the beginning, with the less expensive (not as good) wine being held to the last. However, when they taste the wine Jesus has provided, it is much better than even the expensive wine! Jesus as the



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Creator is shown through this miracle. And, even today, we see that God uses rain to water the vineyards to grow the grapes to turn into wine in the "agricultural and fermentation processes. Here He simply did the process immediately." (The Bible Knowledge Commentary)

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: The Marriage at Cana by Paolo Veronese

• What do you notice about this painting of how the artist depicted the wedding at Cana?

→ NOTEBOOK

Turn in your notebook to a blank page (you may want to leave space of two pages if writing or 3-4 pages if the student will be drawing) where we will begin to create a list of the signs John includes in his gospel. Younger students: Begin your list with the number 1. Either write down a summary phrase (i.e. Jesus turns water into wine at the wedding) or draw a picture to show what the first sign is.

Older students may title their list, and under 1., write down a summary phrase, verse reference, and description of what Jesus' first miracle was.

WEEK 3 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 3

A Plan

📖 Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

In today's reading, we'll hear about a stagecoach going from London to Bristol. The distance between the two cities is about 120 miles. A stagecoach can only go about 5-10 miles per hour, which means the trip would take between 12 and 24 hours! If we drove a car today between those two cities, it might only take us two hours. Today, we will read what plan Curly comes up with to steal some money from that stagecoach. But first, let's look at a picture of a stagecoach.

∞ Image Link: Stagecoach

• Does the stagecoach look comfortable to use for traveling? Do you think it was a secure, safe place to carry money with you for a long distance?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.24-33 "Now Spuds frowned" - "lost his balance."

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 7

Tricked

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Two events happen in today's passage. Do you recall what genre the book of Joshua is? (Historical Narrative) In a narrative (story), events are told as though someone is asking, "And then what happened?"

First, Joshua renews the covenant that God had given to Moses. Do you remember what God promised Moses? (Deut. 28- If you follow and obey God, then you will be blessed. If you do not follow or obey God, then you will be cursed, and things will not go well.)

As we read the story, we might ask, "And then what happened?"

Next, some kings in the land of Canaan come up with a sneaky plan to trick the Israelites. In this context, a "king is the ruler of a single city," and



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these cities were starting to worry about the Israelites. Why do you think they were worried?

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 8:30-9:15

- Why do you think it is good for Joshua to renew the covenant God had made with Moses and remind the people what God had said?
- The Gibeonites dressed in old clothes and brought stale food to try to give the impression that they had traveled from a faraway land. Unfortunately, Joshua and the Israelites "did not ask counsel from the Lord" (9:14). Now they are in a treaty with people from the land of Canaan. What do you think will happen?

WEEK 4 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 7

The Moneychangers in the Temple

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

NOTE: The book Manners & Customs will be used throughout the year to add historical context to passages in the gospel of John. The book itself covers the entire Bible, so at times, the references will include other books of the Bible, but overall, the context is for the historical time period of when the Bible was written. Page numbers will be assigned, and often will include optional (as time and interest allow) readings, or longer readings for older students.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 2:13-25

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Moneychanging" p.162

Optional: "The festivals of Passover and Unleavened Bread (14th-21st Nisan)" p.317-318

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 8

The Sun Stands Still

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Gibeonites have tricked Joshua, but he will remain faithful to the treaty he made with them. Five kings in the land of Canaan decide to come fight against the Gibeonites because now they are all getting worried about the strength of Gibeon and of the Israelites. Next, the Historical Narrative book of Joshua will answer the question, "And then what happened?"

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 9:16-21; 10:1-14

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Joshua Commanding the Sun to Stand Still Upon Gibeon

- What do you notice about this painting? Do you see the people, and do you see Joshua? What do you notice in the sky?



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→ NOTEBOOK

Draw or write a short summary in your notebook about today's reading. Older students may choose a key verse or write a longer summary.

WEEK 4 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 8

Nicodemus

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ INTRO

Nicodemus, a leader of the Jews, came to meet with Jesus to ask questions. "Jesus told Nicodemus how he could see the kingdom of God and how to be born again - by believing in Jesus, God's Son. Jesus came to give eternal life to those who believe." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

John 3:1-21

- Do you think this is the answer Nicodemus was expecting when he came to visit Jesus? Why or why not?

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students may draw a picture of Nicodemus asking his question, or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary of Nicodemus talking to Jesus and Jesus' response.

WEEK 4 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 4

Robbing the Stagecoach

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ INTRO

As we continue to read about Curly's story, let's also learn more about George Müller. After George graduated from college, he became a pastor of a church and married a lady named Mary. He and his friend continued to build their ministry, teaching adults and children about the Bible.

∞ Article Link: Torchlighter George Müller Lived on Prayer
Scroll down and read the paragraph under the heading "Relying on Prayer."

→ READ & NARRATE

p.33-41 "Just then the" - "get outta here."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview the sensitive content on p.35-36, where the plan for the stagecoach robbery is laid out.

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 9

Conquering the Land

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, Student Bible Atlas

NOTE: Today's reading will cover three chapters, but it will skip verses for time's sake.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading covers three chapters of information about Joshua and the Israelites defeating various kings in Canaan. These stories of Israel



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conquering the Promised Land point to God's might and power in fighting for his people, Israel. They are in covenant with him. Do you remember what the word "covenant" means? (a promise) Because God is faithful, he will be faithful.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Today's reading is in two parts:

1. Joshua 10:42-43

- Who did the fighting for Israel, and what is happening as a result? (All the kings are being captured.)

2. Eventually, Israel captures all the kings, and they will have some rest from fighting. While there were many kings who were defeated, we will read just one of the lists of their names.

Joshua 11:23; 12:7-24

→ MAP

□ Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.10 Map 6

Look at the map and note the red dashed line. What does the map key state this red line shows? (Area permanently controlled by Israel.) Do you recognize any of the names of cities on the map that you have heard or read about?

WEEK 5 □ 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 9

John the Baptist is Pointing at Jesus

□ Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ INTRO

John, the disciple writing the account, shifts his focus to a response John the Baptist gave to those who questioned him.

→ READ & NARRATE

John 3:22-36

"For a short time the ministry of John the Baptist overlapped Jesus' ministry." John the Baptist had always known he was pointing to the coming Messiah, and now that Jesus was here, "Jesus must become greater and John must become less....John willingly and with joy accepted Jesus' growing popularity as God's plan." (Bible Knowledge Commentary)

→ MAP WORK

Let's look at the map of the area Jesus is ministering in. Find the locations marked below where events have taken place in the first three chapters of John.

□ Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas Map 19-20 p.22-23 (Either map can be used for all but Jerusalem and Judea, which are only shown on Map 19) Read the text box p.23 "Jesus in Galilee"

1. Locate Nazareth - the town where Jesus is from
2. Locate Cana where Jesus performed his first miracle
3. Locate Capernaum on the shore of the Sea of Galilee
4. Locate Jerusalem (Map 19 p.22)
5. Locate Judea - referred to as Judean countryside (3:22). (This is the pink shaded area on Map 19)



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WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 10

Dividing the Land

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, Student Bible Atlas, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Joshua chapter 13 all the way through chapter 21 lists how Joshua divided up the land between the tribes of Israel. After all, the book of Joshua "shows how God kept his covenant promise to give the land to Israel. He prepared them to enter Canaan, sent his commander to lead them, provided aid in battles, distributed the land, and renewed the covenant. The division of land, though not much of a story, is an incredible climax of the process that had brought the Israelites from their slavery in Egypt to the land that God had promised to Abraham through the covenant made over four centuries earlier. This is fulfillment of covenant promise on a grand scale." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

Our reading will be in three parts:

1. Read Joshua 14:1-5.
2. Read Joshua 16:1-10. Chapter 16 is an example of what these chapters list as far as boundaries of the inherited land that each tribe received. Other chapters define the boundary of the other tribes' lands.
3. Read Joshua 21:43-45. These verses give a summary of the purpose of the entire book of Joshua. They could be called the Key Verses or Main Verses of the book.

- How would you summarize the purpose of the book of Joshua according to these verses?

→ READ

Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas, p.11 Map 7 "Dividing the Land"

On the map, find the area that was given to the tribe of Ephraim that you read about in chapter 16. Locate the Jordan River. Why would it be good to have your land inheritance touch water?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may consider copying down the key verses of Joshua (21:43-45) or writing a summary of today's reading.

WEEK 5 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 10

Woman at the Well

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ INTRO

John's gospel moves from Jesus meeting with Nicodemus - a high-ranking Jewish leader - to telling of Jesus meeting a Samaritan woman, who would have been seen as a low rank of person. The Jewish people hated the people group known as the Samaritans, and as they traveled, they would go out of their way to avoid walking through Samaria. However, today we will see that Jesus chose to walk through Samaria, where he meets this Samaritan woman at a well. Imagine the long walk: "This three-day journey encompasses over seventy miles of rugged rock roads in a hot, dry climate. Your face is beet red from the heat, your body is sweating,



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and your mouth is parched dry - my, what you wouldn't give for a drink of water! Are you there yet? You're relieved when the tired and sore feet of Jesus take refuge during the heat of the noonday sun at Jacob's well. Finally, a water break!" (The Gospel of John, Armijo, Mitchell and Krause)

→ READ & NARRATE

John 4:1-15

• After the long, hot walk, the water from the well would definitely satisfy the traveler's thirst, but Jesus speaks to the woman about a living water that will satisfy her thirst forever. "...The water Jesus gives provides continual satisfaction of needs and desires. In addition one who drinks His living water will have within him a spring of life-giving water... Jesus was speaking of the Holy Spirit who brings salvation to a person who believes and through Him offers salvation to others." (Bible Knowledge Commentary) John includes these stories to show that Jesus' message of salvation was available to all - whether you were a Jewish leader or a Samaritan woman at a well.

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students: Draw a picture of the woman at the well meeting Jesus or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down one or more verses from today's passage.

WEEK 5 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 5

What About Curly's Share of the Money?

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.41-51 "The coach was" - "his own hands."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview sensitive content on p.47 where Spuds beats up Curly in anger and p.48 where Curly's father's behavior is described.

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 11

Joshua Gets Ready for Goodbye

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook; Manners & Customs of Bible Times

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In the first verse of today's reading, Joshua states that he is now old. He gives the first of two speeches to the people of Israel. Imagine you are Joshua. What would you think would be important to tell the people in one of your last speeches you will ever be able to give them?

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 23:1-15

→ READ & NARRATE

Although the people were moving into a land where some cities had walls and homes built (as we read about Jericho), tents were also still used at this time. Read the passages on tents and dwellings, and view the images on p.25 about how a tent was erected.

Manners & Customs "Dwellings" p.20-21 "There are two" - "Ahab for this reason.";

"The Tent" p.24-26 "The tent of" - "door of the leader."

→ NOTEBOOK



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Draw a picture or write a sentence about today's reading. Older students may draw, write a summary, or copy down a key verse (or more!) from Joshua's speech.

WEEK 6 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 11

"Come, See a Man!"

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook (Optional)

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ INTRO

Today's reading continues with the story of Jesus interacting with the Samaritan woman at the well.

→ READ & NARRATE

John 4:16-30

- How do you think the woman felt as she ran from the well to tell everyone who she had met?

→ NOTEBOOK (OPTIONAL)

Younger students: Draw a picture or write a short summary about the passage. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down one or more verses from today's passage.

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 12

Meeting at Shechem

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The first part of today's reading might make you think, "Hm, I feel like I've heard this before." God is speaking through Joshua to remind the people of Israel about their history. The story is given using the personal pronoun "I," which is used 18 times in these verses. "I took...I gave...I sent...I plagued...I brought...I delivered, etc." Speaking in the first person (by repeatedly using the word "I") in the telling of the history, God reminds the people who won the battles thus far and who brought them to where they are today as a people. "God reviewed the marvelous deeds he had performed for Israel's benefit...From first to last Israel's conquests, deliverances, and prosperity were because of God's good mercies and were not of their own making." (The Bible Knowledge Commentary)

"Now therefore" begins verse 14. The word "therefore" is an adverb that means "as a result" or "for that reason." In other words, the people had been reminded of God's leading, and now, as a result of that, they had a decision to make. Read the passage and see what it is they have to choose.

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 24:1-15

- Because God had brought them that far in their story (or history), what choice did they now need to make?
- What do you think their response will be? (We will find out what their actual response was in our next reading.)

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw or write a summary of today's reading. Older students may write a



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longer summary or write down a key verse from the passage.
Alternative Option: As time allows, a short summary of the entire book of Joshua can be written or discussed out loud. Questions could include: What happened in Joshua? Were the people following God? What was Joshua like as a leader?

WEEK 6 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 12

The Town's Response

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook (optional)

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 4:31-42

- How did the Samaritans in town respond when they heard the women's story of meeting Jesus?

→ NOTEBOOK (OPTIONAL)

Add on to your drawing of the Samaritan woman at the well. Younger students may write a short summary of today's reading. Older students, add on to your summary or sketch a picture of the story of the woman at the well.

WEEK 6 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 6

The Raid

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ INTRO

George Müller's orphanages continued to grow, and eventually he opened Ashley Downs, where five buildings were built to house the children.

∞ Article Link: Torchlighter George Müller Lived on Prayer

Scroll down and read the paragraph under the heading "Tears of Joy and 2000 Children."

→ READ & NARRATE

p.52-61 "By Sunday, Curly" - "yourself, do you?"

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the policeman's comment on p.60 regarding the use of the pistol.

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 13

The Choice

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

We are coming to the end of the book of Joshua. Overall, the people have obeyed and followed after God in the book of Joshua. And, according to Deuteronomy 28, what will be the result of following after God? (The people will receive blessings in the form of having land, fruitful crops, lots of kids or growth of their nation, and things will go well for them.) Did they receive blessings as Joshua led them into Canaan? In what way(s)? (conquered enemies, inherited actual land for their tribes, food to eat, no more manna, etc.)

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 24:16-33



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- When the people say that they will serve the Lord, Joshua doesn't seem to believe that they are sincere or genuine. He says, "You are not able to serve the Lord, for he is a holy God. He is a jealous God." What was Joshua emphasizing by saying God was a holy and jealous God? (God is the only God, and their loyalty cannot be divided between other gods and idols. It is not God plus something else.)
- Eventually, he tells them exactly what they need to do. "He had heard the pledge on their lips; now he challenged them to prove their sincerity by their works...There could be no mixing of allegiance to God with idol-worship. A firm choice had to be made then, as in every generation." (Bible Knowledge Commentary) At the end of the passage, Joshua—as the final act of his leadership of Israel—renews the covenant between God and the people. God would bless them if they followed him, and they would be cursed if they did not follow him.

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs p.82 and p.86 (Skip the pages of maps) "When the Jewish" - "began to advance."

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of Joshua renewing the covenant at Shechem. Older students may write down a key verse or write a longer summary of the back-and-forth of Joshua and the people.

WEEK 7 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 13

Jesus Heals an Official's Son

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 4:43-5:1

The official comes from Capernaum to Cana - which is approximately 20 to 25 miles - desiring that Jesus heal his son. When Jesus replies that his son is healed, the official had to believe in Cana that Jesus had healed his son back in Capernaum. The official asked his servants when his son had been healed and it was at the exact time Jesus had "made his promise to him...Jesus' power is able to save from death even at a great distance. His word has power to work." (Bible Knowledge Commentary) John points out in 4:54 that this was the second sign.

- How do you think the boy responded to being healed by this miracle of Jesus'?

→ NOTEBOOK

Turn in your notebook to your list of signs to add the miracle of Jesus healing the official's son.

Younger students: Next to 2. either write down a summary phrase or draw a picture to depict this second sign.

Older students may add to your list by writing down a summary phrase, verse reference, and description of what Jesus' second sign was.

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 14

Judges Begins

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



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→ INTRO

While the Israelites followed God as they entered Canaan, there were little seeds of disobedience showing up throughout the book of Joshua. Now, in the book of Judges, unfortunately, those seeds grow into full disobedience. The book tells the history of Israel over centuries, but the book also encourages the Israelites to obey and be faithful to God.

The word "judges" might remind us of a courtroom; however, at this time in history, the judges were "tribal or national leaders. Often they were military commanders." They would settle arguments and give advice to the people of their territory. "Since Israel had no king or other central political figure, the judges played an important role in Israel's survival." (Basic Bible Commentary)

Sadly, as the book continues, the Israelite's turn further and further away from God, and things are very dark and rather disturbing. Throughout the book, certain judges will be introduced, and we will focus on their stories.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 1:27-36; 2:1-10

- One bad choice Israel made is not driving out the Canaanites completely, and now things start to spiral downward. Why do you think this new generation did not know the Lord or the work that he had done for Israel? How would you imagine Joshua (if he were alive at that time) would feel about this?

→ NOTEBOOK

Turn to a new page to create a title page for the book of Judges. Write the title of the book, and what genre it is: Historical Narrative. Draw a picture or write a short summary of the passage. Older students may write a longer summary or write down key verse(s) of the passage, including 2:10.

WEEK 7 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 14

Healing at the Pool of Bethesda

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Student Bible Atlas; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 5:2-17

This healing of the man at the pool of Bethesda is the third sign "Jesus performed to show that he not only had power from God but also the right to claim to be the Son of God and equal with God."

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Jerusalem at the Time of Christ Map 21 p.24
Locate the Pool of Bethesda. How close is it to the temple?

→ NOTEBOOK

Turn in your notebook to your list of signs to add the miracle of healing at the Pool of Bethesda. Younger students: Next to 3. either write down a summary phrase or draw a picture to show what the third sign is. Older students may add to your list by writing down a summary phrase, verse reference, and description of what Jesus' third miracle was.



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WEEK 7 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 7

Mr. Walk Helps Curly

 Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

NOTE: A video and look at real orphan records from Ashley Downs is listed below as an optional activity if time allows. Feel free to move this to a different week or in week 11 during the "Catch Up" week's lesson time.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.62-71 "Curly and Spuds" - "know the difference?"

- It seems like Mr. Walk wants to help Curly. Does that surprise you? Why or why not?

OPTIONAL:

As time allows, visit the following link to the George Müller Museum to view a short video on Müller, and to view the Downloadable Lesson Plan to learn more about the records of two orphans who came to live at Ashley Downs.

∞ Video Link: An Introduction to George Müller
Scroll down to select the video titled "An Introduction to George Müller." After viewing, click on the yellow box showing "Downloadable Lesson Plan: How Life Has Changed" for a look at what two orphans who arrived at Ashley Downs brought with them as their possessions.

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 15

Cycles

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Israelites have started worshipping false idols and have turned away from following God. And now a cycle (or a series of events that keep repeating) will start that will happen throughout the book of Judges. "The cycles (disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance) show how God demonstrated his power and mercy by delivering his people time after time after his justice had demanded that he bring punishment." (Bible Story Handbook) Sadly, it is also obvious that the leaders of the Israelites are just as bad as the people. In the cycle, the punishment they experienced was in the form of oppression, being conquered by an enemy, or even being enslaved.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 2:11-23

WEEK 8 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 15

Jesus Claims To Be the Son of God

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?



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→ READ & NARRATE

John 5:18-29

- Why were the Jews upset with Jesus?

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 16

Othniel

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

NOTE: There are two options for the reading today. For the second option of reading (3:7-26), preview the passage, as there is an instance of violence as King Eglon gets stabbed. However, the story is also a great example of the humanity included in the Bible.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading introduces the first judge, Othniel. Recall that there are cycles in the book of Judges that involve disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance. Each time that cycle happens, their decline into disobedience, idolatry, and sin is even worse. As we read, listen for those steps in the cycle.

→ READ & NARRATE

Younger Students: Judges 3:7-15

Option #2: Judges 3:7-26

→ NOTEBOOK

∞ Image Link: Cycle of Judges

Draw and/or label the cycle that is in the book of Judges. You can come up with your own words or use the following for the steps of the cycle: disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance. An example is given at the link. (Your chart/cycle does not need to look exactly like this!) Older students can put verse numbers from today's reading about Othniel next to each step (i.e., Disobedience 3:7).

WEEK 8 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 16

A Witness

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

In today's reading, the word "witness" is used. What is a witness? In John's gospel, this idea of a witness or testimony is important. At the start of his gospel, he tells about John the Baptist, a man whose "function was that of a witness. A good witness tells the truth as he knows it...Jesus did not need human testimony, but John's work helped people because in their darkness he pointed them to the light." John the Baptist did not perform any miracles, however. "The 'signs' were specific works which God assigned for the Son to do." This showed that God affirmed who Jesus was and witnessed to who Jesus was. (Bible Knowledge Commentary)

→ READ & NARRATE

John 5:30-47



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WEEK 8 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 8

Ashley Downs

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading about George Müller?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, Curly will find himself arriving at Ashley Downs, the orphanage started by George Müller. As a reminder, when it was fully built, there were five buildings where orphan children could live. There could be up to 2,000 children living there at a time! What do you think Curly will think about this place?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.71-80 "You mean to" - "both of you."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Links: Girls in Front of Buildings at Ashley Downs and Boys at Ashley Downs

• IMPORTANT DATES

1849 Ashley Downs Opens

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 17

Deborah and Barak

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading will introduce us to the next judge in Israel's history. The judges "were often as bad as the people. Deborah was certainly an exception to this, as she was a faithful prophetess and brought deliverance in association with the commander Barak...Deborah was first and foremost a prophetess, one who brought God's word to the people. People came to her for decisions because she would inquire of God for them. It is likely that in this particular instance they came to ask God what they should do about the Canaanite armies. She responded by sending for Barak and giving him God's orders." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 4:1-15

→ READ & NARRATE

Over the next couple of lessons, we will read a few passages from Manners & Customs to learn more about how the armies and groups fought at this time of the Old Testament.
Manners & Customs "The horse" p.213 "The horses of" - "back to Jezreel."; p.145 "Iron was originally" - "for the Temple."
Optional: As interest or time allows, the entire passage regarding workers with metal could be read. This gives a short history of the development of metal being used in the times of the Old Testament p.143-145 "workers of metal."

WEEK 9 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 17

Feeding of the 5,000

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?



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→ READ & NARRATE

John 6:1-15

- The feeding of the 5,000 is the only miracle that is included in all four gospels - other than the resurrection of Jesus. Why do you think it is an important miracle to the writers of the gospels?

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Baking Bread" p.43-44

- Does knowing more about the process of baking bread in New Testament times make the story of Jesus miraculously multiplying loaves of bread even more amazing? Why or why not?

→ NOTEBOOK

Turn in your notebook to your list of signs to add the feeding of the 5,000. Younger students: Next to 4. either write down a summary phrase or draw a picture to show what the fourth sign is. Older students may add to your list by writing down a summary phrase, verse reference, and description of what Jesus' fourth miracle was.

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 18

Deborah's Song

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Sisera went into battle confidently, knowing the Israelites were outnumbered and would seemingly be easy to conquer. But God used both human means (the swords of the Israelites) and divine means to defeat the Canaanites. Today's passage is a victory hymn written by Deborah. In it, we see further information as to the divine means God used to crush Sisera by sending a sudden flood to the Kishon River.

→ READ & NARRATE

Younger students: Judges 5:1-15, 20-21

Older students: Judges 5:1-31

- In verses 20 and 21, torrent refers to a flood of waters that overtook the army. If you were driving in chariots, how would a sudden flood of a river slow you down?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture of Deborah, Barak, or the battle they fought against Sisera, or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy key verses down. Optional: Try writing a short victory song or poem celebrating the victory of Israel over Sisera.

WEEK 9 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 18

Jesus Walks on Water

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading last time in the book of John?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 6:16-34



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While we do not know exactly what this boat looked like, a boat was found from the Sea of Galilee and it was about "twenty-five feet long and nearly eight feet wide. It could carry about a dozen men, perhaps as many as sixteen. Such boats were equipped with oars; some had simple masts as well, though a sail was not used in a storm. Because of the atmospheric conditions that result from the Sea of Galilee being nestled between mountains, wind storms are frequent, come on rapidly, and can be severe." (Bible Story Handbook)

- What would it have been like to be a disciple in a storm on a boat and then look out to see Jesus miraculously walking on water toward you?

→ NOTEBOOK

Younger students may draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage, while older students may write a longer summary or copy down a verse or more from the passage.

WEEK 9 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 9

Curly Tries to Settle In

 Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.81-88 "The man who" - "was otherwise bare."

- Why was Curly lonely even though he was surrounded by other boys his age?

★ TEACHER NOTE

As an interesting historical note, the author Charles Dickens was very concerned with the condition of orphanages during this time period, as you may be familiar with in his writings. Dickens visited George Müller's orphanage and was reassured by seeing the good conditions in which the children were being cared for.

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 19

Gideon

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Israelites experienced peace for 40 years under Deborah's judgeship (5:31b), but then their cycle of disobedience began again, and they were conquered by the Midianites. Let's ask the question that the books of Historical Narrative answer: And then what happened?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 6:1-4, 11-24

- Why do you think Gideon asked for a sign?

→ READ, VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Terebinth tree

1. View the image of the terebinth tree, a relative of the oak tree.
2. The Midianites were a semi-nomadic tribe, which means they traveled from place to place at times. So they liked to attack when the crops had been recently harvested (v.3-5).

Manners & Customs "The Gezer Calendar" and "Grain crops" p.86-90 (Skip p.88-89) "By the time" - "for warmer days."; "Threshing" p.94 "The separation of" - "to his enemies."

- Take a couple of minutes to look at the schoolboy's calendar in the text box labeled "The Gezer Calendar." If you live in an area where crops are grown, how does your area's calendar match this ancient calendar?



Term 1

WEEK 10 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 19

I Am the Bread of Life

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 6:35-51

→ NOTEBOOK

While we continue our list of signs, we are also going to start a new list of Jesus' seven "I Am" statements found in the book of John. Turn in your notebook to a two page spread, or (if drawing), turn to where you have 3 or 4 blank pages. Begin by writing the title (use your own words if you would like!): "7 I AM Statements by Jesus"

Younger students: Write the number 1., then draw a symbol or picture of the first I Am statement of Jesus. (I.e. draw a loaf of bread)

Older students: Number your list, and write a short statement or summary of Jesus' first I Am statement. Include the verse reference.

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 20

Gideon and Tests

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, there are a few tests that take place. First of all, Gideon uses "the dew and the fleece for an oracle. In an oracle, a yes-or-no question was posed to deity, and some mechanism was designated for deity to answer...Since God had already sent an angel to tell him that he was supposed to lead the armies into battle, Gideon wanted to check to see if those orders were still in place." Once the normal result happened, Gideon flipped it because he still doubted. "So with great apology (appropriate, since God had already given instruction), he then asked for the indicator to be switched; having the fleece dry and the threshing floor wet. This does indeed show a lack of faith on his part." (Bible Story Handbook) The second tests have to do with how the warriors drink from the water. Gideon once again was being asked to put his faith in God, going before the Israelites to fight their enemies.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 6:25-40; 7:1-11

(In order to keep the story together, today's reading is a little longer than usual. If additional time is needed to finish today's reading, the next lesson time can be used.)

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or choose one or two main verses from the passage to copy into their notebooks.



Term 1

WEEK 10 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 20

Traitor

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 6:52-71

- Do you think the disciples understood what Jesus was teaching them? Why or why not?
- Does it surprise you that Jesus called out someone who was a disciple but would betray him? Why or why not?

WEEK 10 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 10

The Prayers of George Müller

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.88-95 "Just outside their" - "get to it."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview sensitive content on p.94 where Müller shares the story of his drinking at the tavern in his younger days.

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 21

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 21

Catch Up

Materials: As needed

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 22

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 22

Catch Up

Materials: As needed

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.



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WEEK 11 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 11 <i>Catch Up</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings. If you have not had time to view the video and information shared in Lesson 7, you could also use this time to do that.	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 23 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Joshua	
WEEK 12 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 23 Materials: EXAM WEEK	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Joshua	
WEEK 12 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 24 Materials: EXAM WEEK	
WEEK 12 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller	



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 25

Gideon's Battle

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Gideon has his army put together to go up against the Midianites. Today we will read about that battle.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 7:15b-18 (begin at "And he returned"), 19-23; 8:22-27, 33-35

- How did the Israelites respond after Gideon died? (v.33-35)

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs p.17 Text box titled "The Priest's Clothing"
"In the ancient world around Israel, just as the gods were fed (sacrifices) and housed (temples), they were also clothed (that is, the images were). It is possible that Gideon's ephod represented the clothing of Yahweh (not on an actual image) just as the ark was the footstool of Yahweh's throne." (Bible Story Handbook) The ephod could be used as an oracle to discern God's will. In this sense, this particular ephod was idolatrous and inappropriate.

Optional: Turn back to p.12-13 to look at the images of typical clothing during Bible times.

WEEK 1 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 25

Feast of Booths

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 7:1-14

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "The festival of Tabernacles or Ingathering" p.319-320

The Feast of Booths mentioned in today's reading is sometimes referred to as the Festival of Tabernacles, Ingathering or by the Hebrew word Sukkot.

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 26

The Cycle of Judges

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

After Gideon, there were another 40 years of peace for the people of Israel. But sadly, the cycle begins again.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 10:6-18



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- When strong enemies came up against them, why do you think the Israelites tended to turn away and begin worshiping the other people's gods? (v.6 "And they forsook the Lord and did not serve him.")
- Open your notebook to the drawing you did of the cycle of Israel in the book of Judges. How are you seeing this cycle in the life of the Israelites in our reading of Judges so far?

WEEK 1 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 26

Jesus Speaks at the Temple

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 7:15-31

- What is the response of the people who hear Jesus speak?

WEEK 1 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 13

George Müller's Prayers

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading about George Müller from last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.95-104 "The old man" - "while he slept."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview sensitive content on p.96, 103 & 104 where Curly's dad is referenced being drunk/drinking.

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 27

The Birth of Samson

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The cycles in the book of Judges "show how God demonstrated his power and mercy by delivering them time after time after his justice had demanded that he bring punishment." Samson is the next judge of Israel, and he is "worse than all the other judges as he pursued his own...personal agendas, yet God still used him to deliver the Israelites." (Bible Story Handbook) In the Bible, Samson, who we will meet today, and Samuel, who we will meet later in the year's readings, are the only two for whom the Nazirite vow extends to someone's entire lifetime. Typically, the vow was taken for a specific, limited time to show a high devotion and dedication.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 13:1-20, 24-25

WEEK 2 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 27

Living Water

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



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→ READ & NARRATE

John 7:32-44

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Living water" p.308

After reading the text box, take some time to view the image of the Capernaum Synagogue. What do you notice about the drawing of the synagogue?

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 28

Honey from a Lion

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

As we begin Judges 14, Samson is now grown up. He wants to marry a woman from the Philistines, but he is to be a deliverer of the Israelites. Is it a good idea for him to marry a Philistine woman?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 14:5-19

- "In ancient literature, kings and heroes were sometimes portrayed as killing a lion. While this episode fits a standard heroic feat, it also demonstrates Samson's disregard for his vow, as he did not hesitate to scoop honey from the corpse of the lion." (Bible Story Handbook) After reading this passage, what do you notice about Samson and how he acts or behaves? Does he fit your idea of a hero?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture of today's passage or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down a couple of main verses from the reading.

WEEK 2 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 28

Caught in Sin

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 7:45-8:11

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "The Pharisees" p.81

Increasingly, the Pharisees are accusing Jesus of being uneducated and unknowing of the Law. So they continue to challenge him. Read the passage regarding "The Pharisees" and how education was viewed in this context.

- How does Jesus respond to the Pharisee's challenges against him?

WEEK 2 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 14

Prayer for the Boiler

 Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall from our reading from last time about George Müller?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Please preview sensitive content on p.104-105 where Carly's dad's behavior continues to be described.



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→ READ & NARRATE

p.104-112 "In the morning" - "he was doing."

- Why do you think Curly decided to leave Ashley Downs? Why was it hard for him to understand the love of God?

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 29

Samson's Revenge Against the Philistines

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 15:1, 3-20

→ READ & NARRATE

The passage from Manners & Customs in the Bible we will read today is a summary of warfare before there was a monarchy (kings over the entire nation of Israel), including some battles we have read about this year in Joshua, Judges, and now into First Samuel.

Manners & Customs p.260-262 "Warfare is an" - "no standing army."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview today's passage for sensitive content regarding Samson's wife, her dad's offer of her sister, and the Philistines' subsequent reaction by burning up her and her father.

WEEK 3 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 29

I Am the Light of the World

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 8:12-30

→ NOTEBOOK

Continuing the list of Jesus' seven "I Am" statements found in the book of John, add the next statement to your list. "I am the light of the world."

Younger students: Write the number 2., then draw a symbol or picture of the first I Am statement of Jesus. (I.e. you could draw a lamp or candle)

Older students: Number your list, and write a short statement or summary of Jesus' second I Am statement. Include the verse reference.

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 30

Delilah Manipulates Samson

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

NOTE: The following note may be helpful if any questions arise from today's reading, where in verse 15:20, it states that the "Lord had left him."

"In the Old Testament, the Spirit of the Lord was usually seen in empowering people to a task. Today we talk of the Spirit's indwelling people when they become Christians. These are very different things, and therefore this incident in Judges should not be viewed as the beginning of Samson's spiritual relationship with God. The endowment of the Spirit here had to do with his role as general." (Bible Story Handbook) Samson's choices are selfish, and yet God continues to use him as an instrument to accomplish His will.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

• EXTRA HELPING

Read p.150-151 in Manners & Customs of Bible Times to find out more about weaving and the loom and pin Delilah used to attempt to defeat Samson.



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→ INTRO

Samson meets Delilah, a woman who took a bribe (payment) from the Philistines to help weaken and defeat Samson. She accepts 5,500 shekels of silver, which, at that time, a typical wage would only be about 10 to 12 shekels for an entire year's worth of work! "And then what happened?"

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 16:4-31

- Delilah gets the best of Samson, but in v.28 Samson asks God to give him strength one more time in order to defeat the Philistines. Why do you think God gave him strength in this situation?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of Samson and Delilah. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down one or more important verses from this passage.

WEEK 3 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 30

The Truth Will Set You Free

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

As mentioned previously, John focuses on truth throughout his gospel and does so again in today's reading. Why do you think truth was an important point to John's message?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 8:31-47

- As Jesus answers the people he states that there is no truth in the devil and his message. How does this contrast with the message and person of Jesus? (vs.31)
- Do you recall John's purpose statement about why he is writing the book of John? (See 20:30-31 if needed) How does knowing this help answer the question of why truth was important to John?

WEEK 3 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 15

A Cheer for Curly

 Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Although Curly is a fictional or pretend character in a book, there were real children who lived at Ashley Downs. Today, view the second video and look at the lesson information from the George Müller Museum to learn more about the orphan records that were kept about the children who lived at the orphanage.

∞ Video Link: An Introduction to Orphan Records

Scroll down to view the Introduction to Orphan Records video.

After viewing, click on the Downloadable Lesson Plan: Using Records to Understand People of the Past and read about the Pickernell Sisters.

• IMPORTANT DATES

1898 - George Müller Dies



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→ READ & NARRATE

p.112-121 "After breakfast, Mr Müller" - "over, and out?"

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 31

Micah

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Do you recall what genre of books these are that we have been reading? (Historical Narrative) Typically, Historical Narrative books answer the question "and then what happened?" However, in these final chapters of Judges, that pattern changes a bit. These stories are not what happened next; rather, they tell stories of what happened during the time of the judges we have been reading about.

In the final chapters of the book of Judges, no further judges are introduced. "No note of Israel's sin, of outside oppression, of a cry for help, or of God's provision for a hero-judge to save the people. These chapters are simply additional bits of history that the editor apparently did not want to leave out." (Basic Bible Commentary) The stories may have been used to show the moral decay the people had experienced during the time of the judges.

→ READ & NARRATE

Let's read the first of the stories in these ending chapters. Micah, whose name (ironically) means "Who is like Yahweh?," is introduced in verse 1. In verse 2, he's going to tell his mom that the money stolen from her was actually taken by him. How do you think his mom will respond to this? Let's read to find out what this mom and son do next.
Judges 17:1-13

- Did Micah's mother respond to his stealing the money in the way you thought she would? Why or why not?
- Read 17:6, a key verse of the book of Judges, again. What do you imagine it would be like to live in a land where this was how people were living?

WEEK 4 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 31

Jesus Heals a Blind Man

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Over the next couple of New Testament lessons, the reading will tell us of Jesus healing a blind man. "This extensive healing account is the climactic sign of the first section of the Gospel as it details a particularly extraordinary healing and includes lengthy discussion of the healed man with the religious leaders over the nature of Jesus, particularly the unlearned man's rebuke of the leaders." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

John 8:48-9:7

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Medicine in Jesus' time" p.156-157



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→NOTEBOOK

The next sign is Jesus healing the blind man. Add this to your list in your notebook. Younger students could do this by drawing a picture or short summary of the miracle. Older students can add the miracle to your list, the reference where it is found and a summary of what happened.

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 32

The Danites Look for Land

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Judges 18:1-13

2. Manners & Customs "The dearth of priests"

Younger Students: p.327 "When the Jews" - "breaking the basic commandments."

Look at the picture of the priest on p.326. The ephod is the embroidered garment overlaying his tunic.

Older Students: "The Levites" p.325-327 "Levi, one of the" - "breaking the basic commandments."

WEEK 4 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 32

Arguing Over a Miracle

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 9:8-23

• Why were the Jewish people angry that Jesus healed the blind man on the Sabbath?

WEEK 4 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 16

Christmas for Curly

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.121-129 "Suddenly, he was" - "sing another carol."

• How did the character of Curly change from the beginning of the book to the end of the book?

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 33

Danites Move the Idols

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today we will read the second half of the story of the Danites. They have arrived at Micah's house and notice Micah's idols. What do you think they



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will do with them?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 18:14-31

- Why do you think the author takes care to include the fact that the priests of the Danites set up Micah's idols at their new place in v.30-31?

WEEK 5 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 33

Do You Believe?

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 9:24-41

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 34

Naomi and Ruth

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The book of Judges ends by repeating the sad statement one more time: "In those days there was no king in Israel. Everyone did what was right in his own eyes." Today we will begin the book of Ruth, which begins with a verse saying the story took place while the judges were ruling. Elimelech moves his family away from the city of Bethlehem to Moab because there is a famine. Moabites were an enemy of the people of Israel, but in that land, Ruth, a Moabite woman, marries into Naomi's family and shows faithfulness.

Ruth is a short, four-chapter-long book that shines in the midst of the darkness, because the story of Ruth holds hope. While the book of Judges shows us God can still work through people who are disobedient, foolish, and selfish, the book of Ruth shows us what he can do through people who are faithful to him.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Ruth 1:1-18

"Whenever people were forced to leave the covenant Promised Land, it can be construed as either punishment or neglect of God. Since this story is in the judges period when the people were constantly unfaithful, we can infer that the famine was part of God's judgment. Drought and famine were included in the curses for violating the covenant (Deut. 28:23-24)." (Bible Story Handbook)

- How is her loyalty and faithfulness different from what most people chose in the book of Judges?

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Manners & Customs

p.83 Locate the town of Bethlehem where Elimelech's family was from. Find Moab, where the family moved and Ruth was from. What body of water lies between the two locations? (Salt Sea or Dead Sea)

→ NOTEBOOK



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Create a title page for the book of Ruth. Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage. Older students may write a longer summary or choose to copy down key verse(s) from the reading.

WEEK 5 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 34

I Am the Good Shepherd

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, Manners & Customs, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 10:1-21

→ READ, VIEW & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "The sheepfold" and "The good shepherd" p.130-131

View the short video showing sheep responding to the shepherd's voice

∞ Video Link: Sheep Know the Shepherd's Voice

→ NOTEBOOK

Open your notebook to your list of Jesus' I Am statements. Add "I am the Good Shepherd." Younger students may draw a symbol or picture and older students may write a short summary and the verse reference.

WEEK 5 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 17

More About George Müller

Materials: The Bandit of Ashley Downs: George Müller

→ RECAP

What do you recall about last week's reading about George Müller?

→ INTRO

Today, we will read the end of our book about George Müller. Remember that the character of Curly is a fictional (made-up) story of a boy who met George Müller. However, George Müller was a real, historical figure. In what ways did George Müller share the love of God with others?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.129-132 "Curly spooned the" - "I'll stay too."

Optional: Read "More About George Müller" p.133-136.

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 35

Boaz and Ruth Meet

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Ruth and Naomi return to Bethlehem, where Naomi asks to be called by a new name.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 1:19-2:13

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Harvesting" p.93-94 "The flax was harvested" - "owned the crops."

Look at the images on p.92-93.



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Optional: The passage previously read in Judges about "Threshing" can be discussed again, or if review is needed, can be read: p.94-95 "The separation" - "replaced the flints."

WEEK 6 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 35

Arrest Him

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 10:22-41

- What reason do the Jews give for wanting to arrest Jesus?

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas Map 19 p.22

Locate the Jordan River. What two larger bodies of water does the Jordan River connect to? (Sea of Galilee and the Dead Sea)

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 36

Harvest

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 2:14-3:5

- How do you think Boaz's kind treatment of Ruth encouraged Naomi?

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Winnowing" p.96-97 "In the evening" - "was not stolen."

WEEK 6 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 36

Lazarus

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 11:1-16

WEEK 6 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 18

Adoniram the Teacher

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about George Müller from our reading last time?

→ INTRO

The second book we will read for Church History this year is "Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold," where we are introduced to Adoniram Judson, a historical person who lived a life of pursuing God through faith as he lived his life wanting to bring the gospel to the people

★ TEACHER NOTE

Adoniram Judson lost many important people throughout his life, and death is discussed in his story. Notes will be given so the teacher can preview the passage and make adjustments (to skip or adapt sentences) as needed. In today's reading, Judson makes a new friend who then, unbeknownst to him, lies dying in the room at the inn. Note the short references to this on p.11, 12, 14.



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in a country called Burma.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.7-14 "Having hammered in" - "think about that."

- So far in our reading, how would you describe Adoniram Judson?
- How would you describe his faith at this point in his life?

• IMPORTANT DATES

1788 - Adoniram Judson is born

DEFINITIONS

swot (p.14): British slang for a person who studies excessively at the expense of their social life.

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 37

Boaz the Redeemer

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, Boaz refers to himself as Ruth's "redeemer." In the ancient world, a widow's (someone whose husband has died) family would step in to help and provide security for the widow. "This included involvement with the remarriage of those who had been widowed and were without descendants, because descendants provided for each family in the tribe from generation to generation. This is how land was passed and held in the family." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 3:6-4:6

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Boaz and Ruth by Gerbrand van den Eeckhout (1655)

View the image at the link. Does it match how you imagine the scene looked when Boaz and Ruth met? Why or why not?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of what has been happening in the story of Ruth and Boaz. Older students could write a longer summary, or copy down one or more key verses from the passage.

WEEK 7 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 37

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 11:17-30

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 38

Blessings

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

NOTE: Two options are given for the reading about city gates. Choose the one that best fits your student(s).

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Hope is seen in the redemptive story of Boaz and Ruth. Blessings come to them because they are following after God. God is faithful to follow



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through on his promises.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 4:7-22

- Do you recall when the book of Ruth took place? (time of the judges) At the beginning of the book, the family left Bethlehem because of a famine, but at the end of the book, what are some evidences of the blessing Ruth and Boaz experienced because of the faithfulness of God? (Naomi holds her grandson on her lap; the implication is that there is no longer famine as the baby is able to be fed; Ruth and Boaz are happily married; and some students may notice that King David is part of their family line in the future, which means they are also in the genealogy of Jesus, our Redeemer.)

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "The gate"

Younger students: p.175-176 "The gates were heavily defended" - "always be open."

Older students, or for further information about gates of the city: p.174-176 "In the early" - "always be open."

WEEK 7 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 38

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 11:31-44

WEEK 7 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 19

Thinking About Eternity

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading about Adoniram Judson last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.14-22 "Papa uses words" - "this," he instructed."

- What happened in Adoniram's life to make him change his mind about how he felt about God?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.14-20 to adapt as needed as the story of Jacob Eames continues.

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 39

Hannah Prays

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The next two books we will read are First and Second Samuel. These two books continue in the genre of Historical Narrative and will tell what happens next as Israel begins a historical time period of moving from judges to kings. In I Samuel, we meet Israel's final judge named Samuel. The books are named after him, as he is a man who held "three offices: Prophet, priest, and judge." God will eventually use Samuel as an instrument to bring in the reign of King David. (Bible Story Handbook). In today's reading, we will meet Hannah, who is Samuel's mother. She at first cannot have children, but God answers her prayer for a child because



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he is working to bring about his plan "to provide the king-maker (Samuel) of Israel through her."

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 1:1-28

→ NOTEBOOK

Create a title page for the book of First Samuel, which you can write as: I Samuel, or as First Samuel. Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students can create a title page, draw a picture, and write a longer summary of today's passage.

WEEK 8 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 39

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 12:1-14

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 40

Hannah's Prayer & Eli's Sons

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Hannah has had a son and has committed him to the Lord's work. God had a divine reason and plan in mind to help the nation of Israel through Samuel. As he grows up, Samuel serves in the temple and helps Eli the priest. Dressed in an ephod and robe, Samuel was most likely helping Eli personally, but also learning priestly tasks. This may have included "tasks carried out by the Levites. These included preparing animals for sacrifice and taking care of what was left after the sacrifice. There was also wood and water to be hauled." (Bible Story Handbook) Sadly, we will learn that Eli the priest had sons who were disobedient, and Eli was not doing much to stop their misbehavior. Recall that this is still the time of the judges in the life of Israel, and we see how much that disobedience had corrupted every aspect of society, including the priests.

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 2:1-21

WEEK 8 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 40

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 12:15-28



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WEEK 8 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 20

"Someone's Got to Be First"

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold, globe or wall map

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Adoniram Judson?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: globe, wall map, or map link
(Optional) ∞ Map Link: Map of Myanmar (Burma)

In today's reading, Adoniram learns about the country of Burma and how the people there need to hear the gospel message. Since the time of Judson, the country of Burma has had a change in its name (in 1989). It is now called Myanmar. Sometimes a map will have both names. Find the country of Myanmar (Burma) on a globe or wall map.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.23-29 "Flicking back over" - "wild romantic undertaking."

- Being the very first missionary sent from America would be a big undertaking for Adoniram! In what ways do you think he will have to prepare to get ready to go on this mission?

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 41

Eli's Sons

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Eli's sons were corrupting the priestly office, and Eli was not doing anything to stop it.

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 2:22-36

- What do you recall about what a priest's role (or job) was to do? (represent the people before God, bring sacrifices, etc.) Why would this be a very important role?

WEEK 9 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 41

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 12:29-43

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 42

Samuel's Call

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO



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While Eli's sons and Eli are struggling (and failing) to keep the priesthood holy, Samuel continues to grow older. In today's reading, Samuel will receive a special call from the Lord.

→ READ & NARRATE

First, we will read from Manners & Customs about what a prophet in Old Testament times did and what his role was.

Younger students: p.330-331 "A person became" - "and in truth."

Older students: "The prophets" p.328-331 "Alongside the priests" - "and in truth."

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 3:1-21

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a summary of the passage. Older students may write a longer summary, or copy down a verse or more from today's reading. The student may also record any notes of interest regarding what a prophet's role was at the time of I Samuel.

WEEK 9 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 42

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 12:44-50

WEEK 9 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 21

Pirates!

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading about Adoniram Judson?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.31-38 "On 11th January" - "she said urgently."

→ VIEW

You may want to print out this image and put it on your wall timeline.

∞ Image Link: Young Adoniram Judson

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 43

Philistines Capture the Ark

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

NOTE: Two parts of the story can be added in as appropriate for your student(s):

1. "The story of the ark brings an end to the judges period of history, as God's ultimate judgment on the people was to abandon them to their oppressors. He did this by leaving the land and bringing judgement on the Philistines without raising up a judge."
2. A note on the god Dagon and the ark: "The first time Dagon fell in front of the ark, it was as though he was bowing before God." The second time, "his head and arms fell off, which is an indication that he had been slain in battle. In the ancient world enemy casualties were sometimes counted by making a pile of the heads or hand of the slain. The destruction of Dagon was a very visible way for Yahweh to show the Philistines that he had not been defeated." (Bible Story Handbook)



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→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The ark of the covenant is captured by the Philistines in the chapters we will read from today. Let's look at some information about the ark of the covenant before reading the passage.

Manners & Customs

1. Turn to p.301 and look at the image of the ark of the covenant based on the description from passages in the Bible. While nobody knows where the ark is located currently, artists have drawn or tried to show what it possibly looked like. Take a moment to look at the image of the priest as well. Do you remember the name of the overlay he is wearing? (an ephod)

2. Read p.331-332 "Holy objects"

Younger students: p.331 "In the Jewish" - "served the same purpose."

Older students, or as time and interest allow: p.331-333 "In the Jewish" - "of the house." View the image of the priest on p.333. What do you notice about what he is holding, reading, and wearing?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 4:1-11; 5:1-11

- What does this story tell us about the power of God?

WEEK 10 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 43

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 13:1-15

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 44

We Want a King!

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

When the Israelites moved into the land of Canaan, they were separated into their tribes, and there was no central government over them. In today's reading, they will ask Samuel for a king. All the way back to Genesis 17:6, God had said there would be kings from Israel, so the kingship was not wrong. However, "the problem is the reason the people gave for wanting a king. They had come to believe that their problem was a political one, so they were seeking a political solution. In reality their problem was a spiritual one that required a spiritual solution." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 7:5-6, 12-17; 8:4-18

- Why do the Israelites want a king? How does Samuel react to this request? Why?



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WEEK 10 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 44

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 13:16-30

WEEK 10 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 22

La Belle Creol

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading from last time about Adoniram and Ann Judson?

→ INTRO

Ann and Adoniram are still making their way to Burma. While they have already faced difficulty in making their way to Burma, they will face more in today's reading. What motivates them to keep going? (Or: Why do they keep trying to reach Burma?)

→ READ & NARRATE

p.38-47 "Then they realized" - "we should do."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.40 where Burma's tough conditions are mentioned with reference to people being killed.

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 45

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 45

Materials:

Catch up

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 46

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 46

Materials:

Catch Up

WEEK 11 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 23

A Long Journey

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading from last time about the Judsons' journey to Burma?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview statement on p.50 where Ann is informed that Harriet and the baby have died and p.52 when Ann's baby dies.

● IMPORTANT DATES



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→ INTRO The trip has been so long, and yet Adoniram and Ann still have yet to reach their destination! What would it be like to be so far from home and facing so much unknown? But the Judsons kept their eyes on their goal of reaching Burma. → READ & NARRATE p.48-55 "After the two" - "with a flower!"	1812 - Adoniram and Ann arrive in Burma
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 47 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Judges or Ruth	
WEEK 12 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 47 Materials: EXAM WEEK	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 48 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Judges or Ruth	
WEEK 12 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 48 Materials: EXAM WEEK	
WEEK 12 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Adoniram Judson: Danger on the Streets of Gold	



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WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 49

Samuel Meets Saul

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

When the people of Israel begged for a king, what did Samuel warn them would happen if they had a king? (taxes, sons and daughters being put to work and into battles for the king) How do you think the people will respond to Samuel's wise words?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 8:19-22; 9:1-14

- How is Saul described? Can you imagine what you might feel about having a new king?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down key verse(s) from the passage.

WEEK 1 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 49

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 13:31-38

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 50

Samuel Anoints Saul as King

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs; notebook (optional)

NOTE: In today's reading, it states that the "Spirit of the Lord rushed upon Saul." To aid with any questions that may arise from this: "In the Old Testament, the Spirit of the Lord was usually seen in empowering people to a task. Today we talk of the Spirit's indwelling people when they become Christians. These are very different things. This incident should not be viewed as the beginning of Saul's spiritual relationship with God." (Bible Story Handbook) Saul is anointed and set aside for a task God has given him to accomplish.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 9:15-10:1; 10:9-13, 17-24

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Olive oil" p.106-110 (skipping 108-109) "Olive oil took" - "Lord anointed him."

→ NOTEBOOK



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Optional: As time allows, draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down key verses.

WEEK 1 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 50

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 14:1-14

WEEK 1 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 25

Early Days

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading about Adoniram and Ann Judson from last time?

→ INTRO

Both Adoniram and Ann were very good at languages and learning new languages. Growing up, Ann always made friends easily, and now those gifts of being able to easily make friends and learn to speak new languages would be gifts that God would use to share the gospel message.

→ VIEW IMAGE

∞ Image Link: Ann Judson

→ READ & NARRATE

p.56-63 "They walked on" - "son was buried."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.60 where Mrs Carey and her baby lose their lives when a boat overturns. And also preview the bottom of p.62-63, when baby Roger dies and Ann and Adoniram mourn.

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 51

Samuel's Farewell Address

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Chapter 12 is Samuel's farewell address to the people of Israel.
I Samuel 12:1-25

- How do you think Samuel, as an old man now, is feeling as he gives this message to the people?
- Samuel gives a short review of Israel's history to the people. Why is it important for them to remember what has happened in their history?

WEEK 2 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 51

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 14:15-31



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WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 52

Saul is Rejected as King

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

NOTE: We will skip over some verses for the sake of time and because chapter 14 deals with the destruction of the Amalekites.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Saul disobeys God and, as a result, God rejects Saul as king. Saul had been battling other nations, and in one battle, he and his soldiers kept some of the enemy's best animals, counter to what they had been told to do. Samuel will confront Saul with his disobedience. Do you think Saul will listen?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 15:10-31

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down key verses.

WEEK 2 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 52

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 15:1-17

WEEK 2 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 26

Sharing the Gospel

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Adoniram Judson?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.65-72 "I think some" - "dignified and plain."

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Links: Examples of Zayats
Adoniram begins building a zayat. Why did he decide to do this? View the images of what a zayat looks like. What differences do you notice between the two examples? Which one is more similar to the one Judson probably built?

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 53

David Plays for Saul

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO



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Next in the book of I Samuel, the focus begins to shift to the life of David. There are differences between Saul and David and how they followed after God. One Bible commentator (someone who studies and helps explain the Bible) states: "I don't at all mean that David was an entirely good man, or Saul an entirely bad man. No, they were both men with good and evil in them. But they differed greatly in the attitude of their hearts towards God. The Bible speaks of David with decided approval, and of Saul with decided blame. But you must not therefore think it your duty to look only for good in the one, and for evil in the other...You will miss the best of the Bible teaching unless you are quite honest and candid, giving full weight to the evil and the good in each of its characters." (J. Paterson Smyth)

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 16:1-17, 20-23

- What does this passage say about what is important to God? (See v.6-7.) How would you explain that if someone asked you what that meant?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: David Playing the Harp for Saul
View the image of David playing for King Saul.

- What do you notice about the painting? How would you feel about having to play calming music for an upset king?

WEEK 3 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 53

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 15:18-27

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 54

David v. Goliath

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In the next two lessons, we will read the story of David going up against Goliath, a tough, intimidating opponent who is mocking or taunting (in today's sports world, we might call it "trash-talking") the Israelites. "In the ancient world people believed that the gods fought in conjunction with the human armies they supported and that the armies with the stronger god would prevail...As Goliath defied Israel's armies, he was also defying their God—the two cannot be separated. David became indignant for the Lord's reputation, which is a demonstration that he had the quality that God was looking for in a king." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 17:1-27

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down one or more key verses from the passage.



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WEEK 3 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 54

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 16:1-15

WEEK 3 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 27

The Golden Presence

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading from last time about Ann and Adoniram Judson?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.73-82 "27th June, 1819" - "questioned, sometimes forcefully."

- What are some ways Ann and Adoniram worked together as a team to minister as missionaries to the Burmese people?

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 55

David Defeats Goliath

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs; notebook (optional)

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Today we will read the rest of the story of David and Goliath. In this story, we see that God is faithful to what he promised. We also see characteristics of David that help show why he was chosen by God as the next king of Israel.

I Samuel 17:28-53

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "The foot-soldier" p.264-265 "During the rise" - "the Assyrian army."

→ NOTEBOOK

Optional: If you would like to, add more to your drawing you began last time in your notebook, or add any additional information to your summary that you would like to.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the verses regarding David victoriously cutting off Goliath's head after defeating him (v.51-54). One option is to stop at verse 50, then skip to v.55.

WEEK 4 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 55

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 16:16-28



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WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 56

David and Jonathan's Friendship

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

David is yet to be crowned king, but after his victory over Goliath, and over the next few chapters, he "gained the support of every group, beginning with the crown prince, Jonathan." Jonathan is the son of Saul, but he begins a very loyal friendship with David, showing no jealousy, but rather love and a recognition that David was God's chosen next king of Israel. This would be unlikely, because as the son of the king, Jonathan would have been the one to assume the throne after Saul died. Instead, God had specifically chosen David, and Jonathan realizes that.

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 18:1-4; 19:1-7; 20:1-17

WEEK 4 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 56

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 16:29-17:5

WEEK 4 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 28

Good News and Bad News

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall from our reading about Adoniram and Ann Judson last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.82-90 "While his Burmese" - "India for printing."

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 57

David and Jonathan

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

As we continue in I Samuel, do you remember what genre or group of books I and 2 Samuel belong to? (Historical Narrative) Today we will find out what happens next in the narrative, or story, that the author is telling. In the story of David and Goliath, of David and King Saul, or now of David and Jonathan, what are these stories telling us about who God is?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 20:18-42

- What do you think about King Saul's reaction to his son Jonathan? Does



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that seem like a choice a good leader would make? Why or why not?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the story of David and Jonathan to your notebook either through a drawing or a written-out summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down a verse or two from the passage. A question to consider as you write would be: What characteristics did Jonathan and David show in comparison with King Saul?

WEEK 5 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 57

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 17:6-19

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 58

David Spares Saul's Life

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading will finish up the book of I Samuel. We will read about David sparing Saul's life, which means David had a chance to punish and defeat Saul, but instead let him go.

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 24:1-22; 25:1

- Samuel has now died. Imagine the life he lived—leading, judging, being a prophet, and helping put both Saul and David into their roles as king of Israel. What did you notice about Samuel's life and how he lived?

WEEK 5 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 58

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 17:20-18:11

WEEK 5 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 29

War Begins

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Adoniram Judson?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.90-99 "There is too" - "Things looked bleak."

- As Judson describes to Dr Price the things that have been accomplished in Burma, does it seem as though all he has been through and all the work he has done is worth it or is making a difference? Why or why not?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview today's reading, where reference is made to a mother who had a mental illness (p.97 & 98) and her two daughters will come live with the Judsons. A war begins between Burma and Britain. This will lead to Adoniram being accused of being a spy (p.99).



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WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 59

The Davidic Covenant

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

We have reached Second Samuel. When the book was originally written, it was all one book; however, it was so long that it couldn't fit onto one scroll, so the book was divided into two parts. In Second Samuel, we will now see David become king over Israel. The verses we will read today show how, now that "David had been anointed and had shown his mettle, the text develops over many chapters how David gradually gained expressions of support." (Bible Story Handbook) Once David is on the throne, God makes a covenant with him.

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 1:2-4, 11-12; 2:8-11; 5:1-4, 17-21; 6:12-19

WEEK 6 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 59

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 18:12-24

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 60

Davidic Covenant

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

NOTE: Today's reading is a bit longer, so the focus will be on the Bible reading.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

God now makes a covenant with David. In chapter 6:2, the ark of the covenant has been returned to Israel and returned to a "central positioning." God will now bless the nation of Israel through King David. David wants to build a temple for God, which is not an unusual thing for a king to do for the god of the people; however, God says he will "establish a house (dynasty) for David...By separating the temple building from the covenant, it is made clear that David did not gain God's favor for his dynasty by building the temple." (Bible Story Handbook) The last part of the reading is a prayer of response from David to God.

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 7:1-29

WEEK 6 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 60

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



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→ READ & NARRATE

John 18:25-40

WEEK 6 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 30

Adoniram In Prison

 Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

NOTE: Two reading selections are given as options. The first reads straight through the chapter, which the teacher should preview due to the conditions of the prison and the threat of death to the prisoners. The second reading takes shorter selections from the chapter to give the context of Adoniram in prison, but does not focus on the more difficult aspects of treatment he was facing.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about our reading about Ann and Adoniram Judson last time?

→ INTRO

Adoniram is caught in the middle of a war between Burma and Britain, and because the people in government do not trust him, he is thrown into prison.

→ READ & NARRATE

Reading option #1: Straight through the chapter: p.101-110 "Prison Diary-Adoniram" - "by God's grace."

Reading option #2: Alternate readings for younger or more sensitive students:

p.101 "Prison Diary-Adoniram" - "formula of arrest."

p.105 Read the "Next Day" and "Beginning October, 1824" paragraphs.

p.108-110 "In March that" - "taken to Amarapura."

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 61

David's Kindness to Mephibosheth

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

David finds out that there was a member of Saul's family who was still alive. This was Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan. David shows kindness and loyalty to the promise he had made to Saul and Jonathan that he would treat anyone in their family line well. David is following through on what he had promised.

Mephibosheth was allowed to eat at the king's table, which "was a way of indicating that someone was under royal protection and care. Whether that person actually ate at the same table or not, provisions or rations were supplied from the king's house." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 9:1-13

- Why would a new king not want anyone from the last (or previous) king's family to still be alive? (Because he was in the line of Saul, he could take over the throne.)
- God had chosen David to be king, and much of what happens in these chapters shows that he is not winning power by making political moves or using strategy to gain power; rather, he is gaining the support of the



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people and is being affirmed as God's choice for the throne over Israel.

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture of today's reading or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down a verse or more from the passage.

WEEK 7 □ 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 61

□ Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 19:1-16

WEEK 7 □ 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 62

David and Bathsheba

□ Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

David was anointed as God's chosen for the throne and has shown thus far that he has character and wishes to follow God's leading. However, in today's story, David fails to make the right choice. He abuses his power and is held accountable by God for this failure.

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 11:1-21

David used his power to "achieve his own sinful ends." As his decisions in this passage affect his family, he will experience much sorrow, reaping the consequences of his sinful choices.

★ TEACHER NOTE

You can decide whether the story of David and Bathsheba is appropriate for your students.

WEEK 7 □ 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 62

□ Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 19:17-30

WEEK 7 □ 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 31

Danger

□ Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Adoniram Judson from our reading last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.111-116 "In March that" - "And he did."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview section on p.115-116 about the threat of the lioness and the prisoners.



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WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 63

The Sheep Owner

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

After it is announced that Uriah had died in battle, Nathan the prophet comes to David and tells him a story about a sheep owner. The story is of an owner who abuses their power, just as David had done.

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 11:25-12:7; 13-15

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of your reading. Older students may write a longer summary.

WEEK 8 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 63

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 19:31-42

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 64

Absalom

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Absalom was a son of King David who turned against him and wanted to take over the throne. He tried to do this by gathering people to be on his side against his father, David.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

2 Samuel 15:1-15, 25-31

- Does what is happening in this passage (i.e., David crying, walking barefoot with his head covered) seem like how you would picture a king behaving? Why or why not?

WEEK 8 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 64

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 20:1-10



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WEEK 8 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 32

Adoniram Continues His Ministry

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

NOTE: An optional reading is given below due to the loss of Ann and two of Adoniram's children. Please preview the material and choose the reading appropriate for your student(s).

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Adoniram Judson?

→ INTRO

Adoniram has been facing very difficult experiences and will face more sadness in today's reading. However, he still desires in his heart to do all he can to spread the gospel of Jesus to the people he is ministering to.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.116-123 "And several days" - "world about Jesus."

Option: p.119-123, Summarize the loss that Adoniram experienced of his wife, Ann, Abby, and Maria, and begin at the second paragraph on p.119 "Adoniram established a..."

- After Ann died, Adoniram experienced heavy sadness. How did his friends and the people around him encourage him and help him through this time?

• IMPORTANT DATES

1826 - Ann Judson dies

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 65

David Cries Over Absalom

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Absalom is killed as he continues to try to take over his father's throne. When King David hears this news, he is very upset about the loss of his son, but Joab comes and confronts him.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

2 Samuel 18:19-33; 19:1-8

- Do you think it makes sense that David is upset about the loss of his son who tried to trick him and take over his throne? Why or why not?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of your reading. Older students may write a longer summary.

WEEK 9 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 65

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 20:11-23



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WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 66

Song of Deliverance

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Open your Bible to 2 Samuel 22. What does the heading say? (David's Song of Deliverance) David was a great writer of poetry and songs. He was writing his psalms while he was experiencing the life situations that were causing him to experience joy, sorrow, repentance, or any number of emotions. Next lesson, we will read a Psalm that directly ties into 2 Samuel 22. Let's start by reading the first part of 2 Samuel 22: Read 2 Samuel 22:1-31.

- What are some ways David describes God in this song? (a rock, fortress, deliverer, rescues him, etc.)
- What are some feelings or emotions you hear in this song?

WEEK 9 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 66

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 20:24-31

WEEK 9 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 33

Adoniram and Sarah's Missionary Work

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ INTRO

As time has gone by, Adoniram has now married Sarah, and the two of them continue to share the good news of Jesus to the people they meet.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Adoniram Judson?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Book of John Translated by Adoniram Judson

As we've been reading, Judson has been working on his translation of the Bible into the Burmese language. View the image of a copy of the gospel of John at the link. Do you see Judson's name on the title page? How do the letters of the Burmese language seem different than the letters you are familiar with?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.124-132 "Is that why" - "doing us good."

• IMPORTANT DATES

1840 - Adoniram completes the translation of the Bible into the Burmese language

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 67

David's Songs

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



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→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. 2 Samuel 22:32-51
2. As we discussed last lesson, the book of Psalms in the Bible contains many of King David's songs and poems. Thirteen psalms were written during the events of 1 & 2 Samuel. In fact, chapter 22 of 2 Samuel is found in the book of Psalms. Find Psalm 18 in your Bible. Read the heading (The choirmaster. A Psalm of David...). Then begin reading Psalm 18. Compare this to 2 Samuel 22. Is it the same?

Optional:

∞ Link: Psalms Written During 1 & 2 Samuel

Look at the linked list of psalms written during 1 & 2 Samuel. Pick one to look up and read.

WEEK 10 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 67

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 21:1-14

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 68

David's Final Words

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Today we will finish up our reading in the book of 2 Samuel, and we will read Psalm 23, written by King David.

2 Samuel 23:1-7

Psalm 23

- David was God's chosen king for the nation of Israel. How was David a "man after God's own heart"?

NOTEBOOK

In your notebook, draw a picture showing something you have learned about King David or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary.

WEEK 10 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 68

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

John 21:15-25

WEEK 10 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 34

Adoniram Marries Emily

Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Adoniram Judson?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.133, as Sarah dies. Adoniram will marry his third wife, Emily, in this chapter.



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→ READ & NARRATE p.133-141 "Although it was" - "the spoken language."	
WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 69 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 11 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 69 Materials: Catch Up	
WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 70 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 11 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 70 Materials: Catch Up	
WEEK 11 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 35 <i>Adoniram's Work Is Over/Catch Up Week</i> Materials: Adoniram Judson: Danger in the Streets of Gold → RECAP What do you recall about our reading about Adoniram Judson from last time? → READ & NARRATE p.142-146 "It was November" - "to the other." If possible, use any extra time to catch up on reading to complete the book. • What are some ways God was with and helped Adoniram over Adoniram's lifetime?	● IMPORTANT DATES 1850 - Adoniram Judson dies
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 71 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: 1 or 2 Samuel	
WEEK 12 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 71 Materials: EXAM WEEK	

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WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 72 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: 1 or 2 Samuel	
WEEK 12 20m New Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 72 Materials: EXAM WEEK	
WEEK 12 20m Church History: Grades 1-3 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Adoniram Judson: Danger on the Streets of Gold	

Bible: Grades 4-6

Examination

Term 1

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

- Tell about Joshua leading the people into Canaan. OR Tell about the fall of the city of Jericho.

Church History: Grades 4-6

- Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China: What are three obstacles Hudson Taylor faced after his decision to become a missionary in China?

Term 2

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

- Tell the story of Gideon the judge. OR Tell the story of Ruth and Boaz.

Church History: Grades 4-6

- Hudson Taylor: Deep in the Heart of China or Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor: Tell a story you remember of a blessing or good thing that happened to either Hudson Taylor or Mary Slessor in their lives as missionaries.

Term 3

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

- Tell about King Saul OR about David and Goliath.

Church History: Grades 4-6

- Trial by Poison: Mary Slessor: Tell what you remember about Mary Slessor's life as a missionary.